The Russian federation's 'foreign policy concept' (2013) mentions that China and Russia share the same fundamental position on critical global issues. Thus, Russia will promote foreign policy cooperation with China in reforming the existing global governance system. In the process, the two countries will seek to address new threats and challenges and cooperate within the UN Security Council, G-20, BRICS, EAS, SCO, and other multilateral forums. In this context, scholar Lo (2014) said that the fundamentals of Russia and China are unaltered. Both sides oppose global governance on Western terms and seek to limit growing American power in international relations. However, Russia and China have a different view of the twenty-first-century multipolar world order. Moscow sees itself as an equal and independent center of global power. At the same time, China's focus is overwhelmingly on the United States, with Russia playing a secondary and supporting role for China.

However, 2015 brought several international relations developments, particularly giving scores of challenges to the Russia–China partnership. For one, Russia's economy registered a negative GDP growth rate with West-imposed sanctions and led to the Russian Ruble and Chinese Yuan's devaluation. China also reported a slow growth rate. Nonetheless, Russia and China signed the ambitious $100 billion trade treaty between China and Russia (Gabuev 2015). A report written by Russian and Chinese experts (2016) called Russia–China dialogue by Russian International Affairs Council stated that Russia and China's main strategic goal today is to build relations and increase the influence of both countries in regional and international affairs. Further, they want to coordinate more closely on critical actions in multilateral formats and regions and develop a typical response to challenge the problems created by the modern world.

Since Russia and China consider that with BRICS, they will have the opportunity to bring back reforms in the international system, both have many convergences and divergences with the BRICS group. These are as follows.

Convergences

Economic Issues

In April 2009, during the London G-20 summit, individual BRICS countries issued an international reserve currency to replace the greenback. In March